

- ▶ Circles are different set of groups, or lists with different permissions. You can add your contacts in these circles to make sure that you don't share your information with those who shouldn't see them.
- ▶ You will get updates from contacts that you have added in your circle. Just like twitter, you start getting updates from those who you added in your circles.
- ▶ You can compartmentalize the information you want to provide to people. If you don't want your Boss to know about your latest vacation, don't let your "Work" circle access your vacation photos and updates.

Basically, Google connects its "Stream" feature with the "Circles" and gives you this awesome ability to compartmentalize incoming and outgoing information easily. This makes handling people easy. Imagine the ability to break down Facebook into its various constituent parts and keep them separate from each other as opposed to one giant feed. That is what Google has done with Plus. There is one main stream where all your friends updates show up then the option to see updates from only certain groups like "Work," "Friends" or "Family." This is the essence of Circles.



Google+ stream and its filters

Here, you can filter your stream by selecting a specific circle. In this picture, no specific circle is selected. Hence, all updates are displayed on Stream (marked in Red). If one of the following circles is selected, then the stream will contain updates only from that specific circle.

Once you have your circles ready, get ready to start posting status messages. But, posting a status update in Google+ is not like sending a Tweet or updating Facebook. The core functions of an update are present - photos, links, video and location - but when you hit "share" it doesn't automatically post your message to everybody in your circles. You have the option